

Broken Cycle

The roads around Moonslumber are no longer safe, people and caravans are disappearing. Some say it started when the dam on the Serene River was built. Perhaps an expedition into the dried-up underground riverbed would provide some answers. Any volunteers?

8) Mekacharger

A buzzing and arcs of electricity emanate from the strange machine. Four slots allow MekaGnomes to recharge, D2 are occupied. Under the watch of a guard, D6 prisoners operate the paddle wheel that powers the machine.

7) Gearspindle's Apartments

The apartment door has no lock; it only opens if a complete seasonal cycle is activated. The library is filled with books on Mekanics and flora... Gearspindle's mummified body is at his desk, slumped over his book. It contains schematics for all his machines, very complex to understand. Smokey, the MekaCat, watches from atop the bookcase.

6) MekaFlora

This large cavern is filled with trees, flowers, and butterflies made of rare, precious metals reflecting green, blue, and iridescent hues. The view is breathtaking. It is dangerous to move here, the metal leaves and petals are razor-sharp. Four levers on the south wall cause the metallic vegetation to change, each corresponding to a season. Leaves and flowers... disappear and reappear depending on the activated season. It is currently set to summer. Being in the room during spring or summer activation is particularly hazardous... Damaging the MekaFlora immediately provokes an attack by 2D6 MekaButterflies with razor wings.

5) Prisoner Cave

About ten filthy mats and a strong smell of urine. D3 MekaGnomes guard D6 chained prisoners who sleep here. They are exhausted and unable to fight but they know the way between here and the two paddle wheels.

Rumors

- Disappearances began when the dam on the Serene was built and the watercourse diverted.
- The underground river has carved through the mountain rock for millennia. What creatures dwell in these caverns? Nobody knows.
- Gearspindle, a master-craftsman gnome, isolated himself in the caves for his experiments long ago.
- On certain evenings, rumblings can be heard rising from the ground. Chatters about a dragon are already spreading!

4) MekaWorkshop

Clang (2 deformities), the oldest MekaGnome, works here, desperately trying to repair gnome malfunctions. The workshop is filled with high-quality, elaborate tools.

2) MekaOil Factory

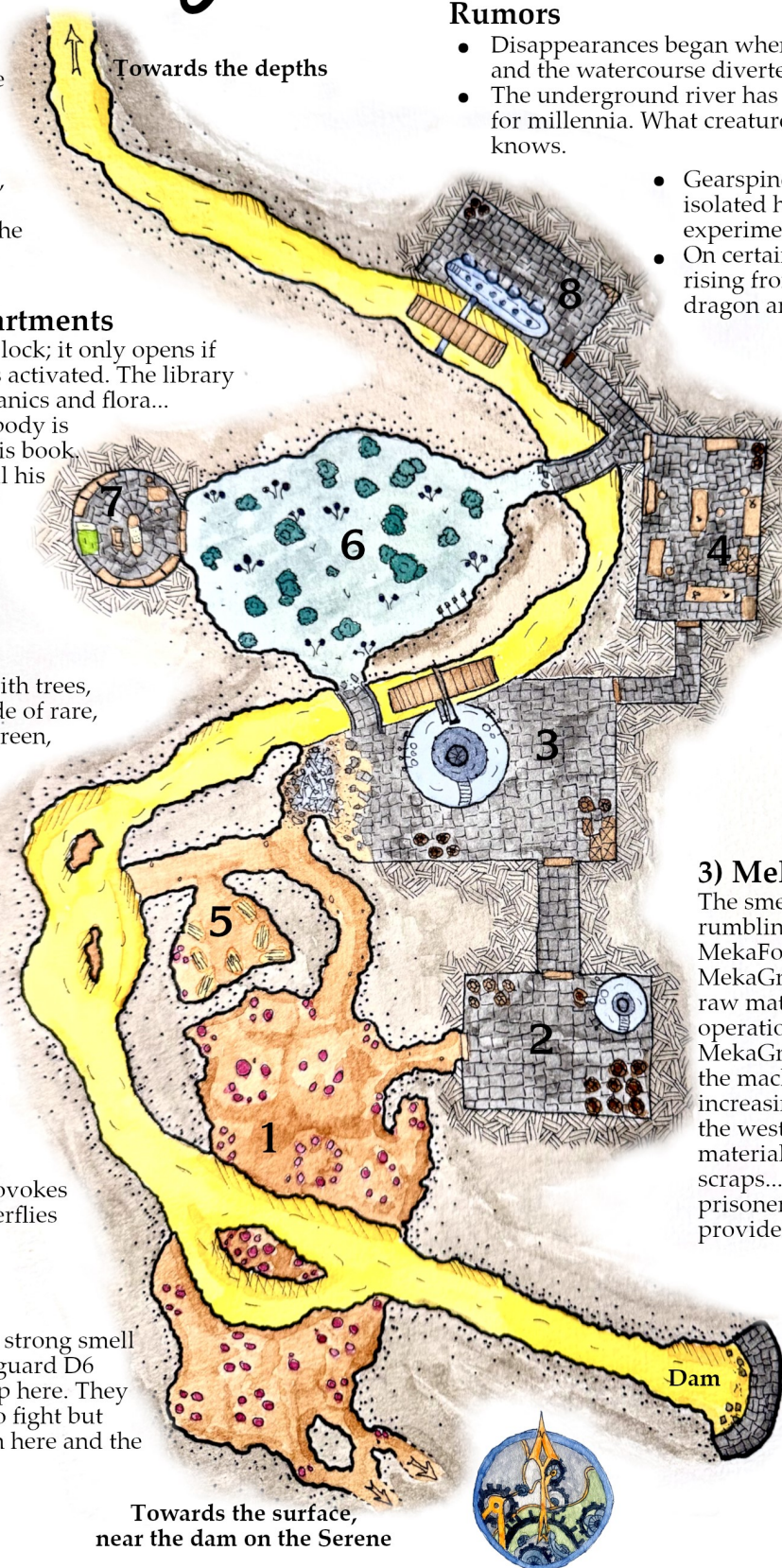
The stench of rot here is nearly unbearable. A large spherical machine extracts MekaOil from PurplePuff mushrooms, which is then stored in barrels. Once refined, the oil is highly flammable. The oil-covered floor is slippery.

3) Mekamatrix

The smell of burnt oil and the sound of rumbling machinery fills the air. The MekaForge automatically constructs new MekaGnomes. An opening at its top allows raw materials to be fed into it. When operational, the noise is deafening. D3 MekaGnomes bustle around it. Over time, the machine becomes erratic, producing increasingly misshapen MekaGnomes. To the west, a pile of metal debris serves as raw material: remains of MekaGnomes, metal scraps...and a family of giant rats. D6 prisoners operate the paddle wheel to provide energy to the machine..

1) PuffPurple Caverns

These large, sticky purple mushrooms fill the cavern. Besides their woody scent, they tend to explode at the slightest touch when they're fully grown.



MekaDeformities :

Each MekaGnome has a 1 in 3 chance of having a deformity. If so, roll for a second one.....

- 1) Oil-spitting mouth (blinding, slippery, flammable)
- 2) Mechanical whip arm (grappling, immobilizing)
- 3) Steel jaw (never lets go, automatic damage)
- 4) Spring-loaded leg (5m leap)
- 5) Drill fingers (armor-piercing)
- 6) Electric body (contact damage)

Random Encounter, dried riverbed :

- 1) A giant crab hidden under the sand, where it drags its victims
- 2) Quicksand
- 3) Rotten algae producing a pocket of toxic gas
- 4) Refer to the MekaGnome complex table

Random Encounter, MekaGnome complex:

MekaGnomes do not speak but communicate through gestures.

- 1) D3 MekaGnome hunters, metal net, electric rod
- 2) D3+1 MekaGnome guards, whirling flail or pneumatic spike, manacles.
- 3) 1 Aberrant MekaGnome, madly furious, Herculean strength (1D2+1 deformities)
- 4) D3 prisoners on the run

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